

DRAW — Keyboard & Mouse Shortcuts

Quick reference · v2.0.1 · 2026-08-31

Primary = Ctrl (Windows/Linux) or ⌘ Cmd (macOS). **Hold X + ...** = hold that key, then press/click/drag. **L/R/M-Click** = left / right / middle mouse · **Wheel** = scroll. Keys only do the listed thing when not typing in a text field.

Global / Application

?	Open/close the Command Palette (searchable command list)
Ctrl+,	Open Settings dialog
Alt (tap & release)	Open/close the menu bar
Alt+X	Exit DRAW (prompts if unsaved)
Ctrl+Z	Undo
Ctrl+Y	Redo
Ctrl+Alt+N	New Window — another isolated DRAW instance (<i>Settings</i> → <i>General</i> → <i>Allow Multiple Instances</i>)
Ctrl+Alt+K	Cancel the running AI generation (aborts the batch) (<i>AI enabled</i>)

File

Documents & images

Ctrl+N	New canvas (prompts to save unsaved changes)
Ctrl+O	Open / import image (PNG, BMP, JPG, GIF)
Alt+O	Open DRAW project (.draw)
Ctrl+S	Save (silent if previously saved; dialog if new)
Ctrl+Shift+S	Save As (always prompts)
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+S	Export selection as cropped image
Ctrl+Shift+Q	QB64 Code Export — re-export to last project path (no dialog)
Alt+1 ... Alt+9	Open recent file #1–#9
Alt+0	Open recent file #10

Reference image

Ctrl+R	Toggle reference image on/off (loads one if none)
Ctrl+Shift+Wheel	Adjust reference-image opacity (5–100%)

Reposition mode (View → Reposition Reference):

Drag

 move ·

Wheel

 scale ·

Arrows

 nudge 1px ·

Enter

 confirm ·

Esc

 cancel.

.draw

 files are PNG images with an embedded

drAw

 chunk preserving layers, blend modes, palette, tool state, reference image, and more. Standard image saves flatten visible layers. Full menu list: File menu (New from Template, Open Aseprite/PSD, Import ANSI, Export As, Export ANSI/Layer/Brush, Extract From/To Grid).

Edit · History · Clipboard

Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y	Undo / Redo (Ctrl+Shift+Z also redoes)
Ctrl+C	Copy selection
Ctrl+Shift+C	Copy merged (all visible layers)
Ctrl+X	Cut selection (copy + clear with BG)
Ctrl+V	Paste at cursor (centered, engages Move)
Ctrl+Shift+V	Paste from OS clipboard
Ctrl+E	Clear/erase selection (BG color, or transparent for wand selections)
Ctrl+Alt+C	Copy to new layer
Ctrl+Alt+X	Cut to new layer
Delete	Clear (selection, or whole layer if none)
Backspace	Fill with foreground color
Shift+Backspace	Fill with background color

Paste workflow: select (**M** / **W**) → **Ctrl+C** / **Ctrl+X** → move mouse → **Ctrl+V** (auto-engages Move) → position → **Enter** apply / **Esc** cancel.

View · UI · Zoom · Pan

UI toggles

Tab	Toggle toolbar
Ctrl+L	Toggle layer panel
F4	Toggle preview window
F5	Toggle edit bar
Shift+F5	Toggle advanced bar
Ctrl+Shift+F5	Reload theme (hot-reload colors + icons)
Ctrl+M	Toggle Character Map panel
F10	Toggle status bar
F11	Toggle ALL UI
Ctrl+F11	Toggle menu bar
Ctrl+Shift+Up	Hide/show menu bar (alt binding)
Ctrl+Shift+Down	Hide/show status bar + color strip
Ctrl+Shift+Left	Hide/show left-side UI (edit bar, layers)
Ctrl+Shift+Right	Hide/show right-side UI (toolbar, organizer, drawer)
#	Toggle canvas border
Shift (hold)	Show crosshair while held
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+G	Toggle grayscale preview
Ctrl+Alt+0	Toggle CRT effect overlay

Zoom & pan

Ctrl+0	Reset zoom to 100% and center
Ctrl+=	Zoom in (25→50→100→200→300... 800%)
Ctrl+-	Zoom out
Wheel	Zoom in/out at cursor
Hold Z + 1...9	Zoom preset 100 / 200 / 300 / 400 / 500 / 600 / 700 / 800 / 1600%
Hold Z + 0	Zoom 3200%
Shift+Wheel	Vertical pan
Shift+Arrows (no selection)	Pan viewport
M-Click + Drag	Pan canvas
Space + L-Drag	Pan canvas
Dbl M-Click	Reset zoom & pan

Zoom snap levels: 25, 50, 100, 200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700, 800%. **Display Scale (window size):** Settings (Ctrl+,) → Display → UI Scale (0 =auto, 1 – 8).

Tools

Press a letter to select a tool. Shift+letter picks the filled/variant form.

B	Brush	Freehand painting (drag)
D	Dot	Single-pixel stamp (click)
L	Line	Straight lines
R / Shift+R	Rectangle / Filled	Outline / filled
C / Shift+C	Ellipse / Filled	Outline / filled
P / Shift+P	Polygon / Filled	Outline / filled
Q	Bezier	Cubic curves (drop anchors, drag handles)
S	Smart Shapes	Parametric shapes; double-tap S cycles sub-tools; toolbar flyout for all types
F	Fill	Flood fill (Shift samples merged canvas)
K	Spray	Spray paint
E / Hold E	Eraser / temp Eraser	Tap = permanent; hold = while held
I	Picker	Eyedropper with loupe
M	Marquee	Rectangular selection
W	Magic Wand	Contiguous same-color select
V	Move	Move/transform selection
Z	Zoom	Click in / Alt +click out / drag region
T / Shift+T / Ctrl+T	Text (VGA / Tiny5 / custom font)	

?	Command Palette
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Smart Shapes and **3D Text** are on the toolbar's Smart Shapes flyout (long-press / right-click): Polygon, Pie/Donut, Rounded Rect, Tab, Pill, Pac-Man, 3D Dice, Bevel Rect, Arrow, 3D Text.

Left vs right button: L-Click draws with FG, R-Click draws with BG (Brush, Dot, Line, Rect, Ellipse, Fill, Spray). Exceptions: Picker R-Click picks BG; Polygon R-Click closes shape; Brush/Dot **Shift** +R-Click draws a connecting line from the last point.

Drawing Modifiers

Shape constraints (while dragging)

Line / Rect / Ellipse	Shift	Constrain to H/V
Brush / Spray	Shift	Constrain to H/V axis
Line / Polygon	Ctrl+Shift	Angle-snap + bypass grid snap
Rectangle	Ctrl	Perfect square
Rectangle	Shift (from center)	Draw from center
Ellipse	Ctrl	Perfect circle
Ellipse	Shift (from center)	Draw from center

Subdivisions (while dragging a Rect / Ellipse / Line)

→ / ←	+/- column divider	+/- spoke	+/- radial spoke
↓ / ↑	+/- row divider	+/- concentric ring	—

(Rect up to 32/axis; Ellipse up to 16 spokes/rings; Line up to 16 spokes. Counts reset each drag.)

Angle snapping

Ctrl+Shift (hold while dragging/clicking) snaps to angle increments **and** bypasses grid snap. Increment set by **ANGLE_SNAP_DEGREES** in **DRAW.cfg** (default 45° → 8 directions; also 30/15/90°). Applies to Line, Polygon, Polygon-Filled, and Brush/Dot **Shift** +R-Click connecting lines.

Line end caps (while dragging Line)

s cycle start cap · **e** cycle end cap (none → arrow → diamond → circle → square → ...).

Smart Shapes (while dragging)

↑/↓ primary parameter · ←/→ secondary parameter · **Shift** constrain aspect · **Space** reposition without resizing · **Wheel** adjust primary. **3D Dice/Text lighting:** **W**/**S** tilt · **A**/**D** (or **Q**/**E**) orbit · **=**/**-** push light · **Hold L + 0-9** intensity preset. **Dice type:** **4**/**6**/**8**/**0**/**1**/**2**/**3** = D4/D6/D8/D10/D12/D20/D30; L-drag wireframe (FG), R-drag solid (BG faces + FG wireframe).

Selection · Marquee · Magic Wand

Selection tools

M	Rectangle marquee
W	Magic wand (contiguous same-color)
—	Freehand / Polygon / Ellipse select (toolbar or command palette)

Marquee mouse

L-Drag create · **Shift+Drag** add (union) · **Alt+Drag** subtract · drag corner/edge handle resize · drag inside move.

Magic wand mouse

L-Click select contiguous · **Shift+Click** add · **Alt+Click** subtract · **Hold E + Click** flood-erase to transparent · **Hold F + Click** flood-fill FG · **Hold W + Click** select from merged canvas.

Selection keyboard

Ctrl+A	Select all
Ctrl+Shift+I	Invert selection
Ctrl+H	Hide/show marching ants (selection stays active)
Hold M + = / Hold M + -	Expand / contract selection 1px
Hold M + Shift+= / Hold M + Shift+-	Expand / contract selection (large step)
Ctrl+D / Esc	Deselect (from any tool)
Arrows	Move selection box 1px
Shift+Arrows	Move selection box 10px
Ctrl+Arrows	Move content 1px (lifts/floats, Photoshop-style)
Ctrl+Shift+Arrows	Move content N px (NUDGE_N)
Ctrl+Alt+Arrows	Clone content 1px (keeps original)
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+Arrows	Clone content N px

As a clipping mask: an active selection clips all drawing tools to inside it. Grid snap (;) applies to marquee drags; Ctrl+Shift angle-snaps + bypasses grid for the start. Stroke Selection lives in Edit menu / command palette.

Layers · Groups · Symbols

Layer keyboard

Ctrl+L	Toggle layer panel
Ctrl+Shift+N	New layer (<i>Ctrl+N is New Canvas</i>)
Ctrl+Shift+D	Duplicate layer
Ctrl+Shift+R	Rename layer
Ctrl+Shift+Delete	Delete layer
Ctrl+PgUp / Ctrl+PgDn	Move layer up / down
Ctrl+Shift+] / Ctrl+Shift+[	Arrange to top / bottom
Ctrl+Alt+E	Merge down
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+E	Merge all visible
Ctrl+G	New empty group
Ctrl+Shift+G	Group from selection (2+ layers)
Ctrl+Shift+U	Ungroup
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+C	Copy Layer to clipboard (for another DRAW window)
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+V	Paste Layer as new layer

Layer panel mouse

L-Click select · Ctrl/Shift+L-Click add/remove from multi-selection · R-Click select+rename · Shift+R-Click cycle blend mode · Alt+L-Click eye solo · Click eye toggle visibility · Drag across eyes swipe show/hide · Click lock opacity lock · Click/Drag opacity bar adjust · Drag row reorder · Wheel scroll list · Wheel on opacity bar adjust · Esc cancel drag · Click triangle collapse/expand group.

19 blend modes (Shift+R-Click a row to cycle). Groups have their own opacity/blend (Pass-Through default) and can nest. Symbol layers link a parent to children (Layer menu: Convert to Symbol, Add Instance, Sync, Rasterize, Detach, Select Parent).

Color · Palette · Palette-Ops

Color keyboard

X	Swap FG/BG (including transparency state)
Shift+Delete	Set BG to transparent
Ctrl+Alt+R	Load a random palette
F1 / F2 / F3	Drawer Brush / Gradient / Pattern mode

Palette strip mouse

L-Click swatch set FG · R-Click swatch set BG · Wheel scroll · Shift+Wheel fast scroll (32) · Click ◀/▶ scroll · Click palette name switch-palette dropdown · letter keys (in picker) jump to palette.

Status-bar swatches

Click FG swatch / Click BG swatch → open color picker.

Palette-Ops mode (toggle via organizer button)

L-Click swatch wand-select matching pixels · Dbl L-Click change color (replaces on canvas) · R-Click toggle mark · M-Click delete color (remap to nearest) · M-Click marked batch-delete marked · Shift+M-Click insert blank transparent · Drag reorder · Esc exit.

Grid · Symmetry · Smart Guides

Grid

'	Toggle grid
Shift+'	Toggle pixel grid (400%+)
;	Toggle snap-to-grid
Ctrl+'	Cycle geometry (Square → Diagonal → Isometric → Hex)
. / ,	Grid size +1 / -1 (uniform, 2-50px)
/	Toggle alignment (Corner ↔ Center)
Ctrl+Shift+ /	Set grid size from brush; enable center align + snap
Hold G + →/←	Grid width +1 / -1
Hold G + ↓/↑	Grid height +1 / -1
Hold G + R	Reset grid offset (0,0)
Hold G + Shift+R	Reset grid size to theme default
Hold G + Ctrl+R	Reset offset + size
Ctrl+Shift (hold)	Temporarily bypass grid snap

Cell Fill (View → Grid Cell Fill): Fill tool fills grid cells per geometry.

Symmetry

F7	Cycle mode (Off → Vertical → Cross → Asterisk)
F8	Fill-Adjustment mode (if custom brush/paint mode) — otherwise turn symmetry off
Ctrl+L-Click	Reposition symmetry center

Status: **SYM:0/1/2/3**. Works with all drawing tools.

Fill Adjustment mode (F8 with custom brush/paint mode)

Drag reposition tile origin · Wheel scale uniform · corner handle scale XY · arm handles scale X/Y · rotation handle rotate · Enter /L-Click-outside apply · Esc /R-Click cancel.

Smart Guides

View → Smart Guides (visibility) · Edit → Snap Smart Guides (snap).

Text · Character Map · Fonts

Text editing

T / Shift+T / Ctrl+T	Text: VGA / Tiny5 / custom font
Type	Enter text
Enter	New line
Backspace / Delete	Delete before / after cursor
Esc	Apply/finish (commit text layer)
← / → / ↑ / ↓	Move cursor char / line
Home / End	Start / end of line
Ctrl+← / →	Move by word
Ctrl+Home / Ctrl+End	Start / end of text
Shift+... (arrows/Home/End)	Extend selection
Ctrl+Shift+← / →	Select word
Ctrl+A	Select all text
Dbl/Triple/Quad-Click	Select word / line / all
Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y	Text-local undo / redo (within edit session, 128 states)

Per-character formatting (while editing)

Ctrl+B bold · Ctrl+I italic · Ctrl+U underline · Ctrl+Shift+X strikethrough · Ctrl+Shift+. / Ctrl+Shift+, size +/- · Alt+→ / Alt+← kerning +/- · Ctrl+Alt+↑ / Ctrl+Alt+↓ baseline raise/lower. Outside an active edit, Alt+U picks up the style at the cursor and Alt+V pastes it.

Character Map (Ctrl+M)

L-Click cell select glyph · CHAR button toggles Character Mode · Alt+U pick FG+BG from glyph under cursor. In Character Mode: arrows move a *virtual cursor*; F1-F12 insert ANSI block chars (█ █ █ █ █ █ █ █); DOT/RECT tools fill cells with the glyph.

Fonts

Middle-click the Text toolbar icon → load TTF/OTF. **TheDraw (TDF)** fonts: [TDF] text-bar button / Tools → TheDraw Font / palette tdf. Browser keys: type filter · Tab cycle focus · ↑/↓ move · PgUp/PgDn page · Home/End first/last · F2 favorite · Enter use · Esc cancel. **CBF** (color bitmap) fonts chosen from the font dropdown.

Brush · Custom Brush · Spray

Brush

[/]	Brush size – / + (fine, ±1)
Ctrl+Wheel	Brush size presets (1/3/5/7)
`	Toggle brush preview / cursor visibility
\	Toggle brush shape / cursor shape
F6	Toggle pixel-perfect mode

Custom brush

Ctrl+B	Capture selection as custom brush / clear when brush active
F9	Toggle recolor mode (paint brush in FG)
Shift+0	Apply 1px outline in BG (disables recolor)
F12	Export custom brush as PNG
Home / End	Flip custom brush H / V
PgUp / PgDn	Scale custom brush up / down
/	Reset custom brush scale

Spray (K)

L-Click spray FG · R-Click spray BG · Shift constrain axis · brush size sets nozzle + radius (2× per level). Works with symmetry, selection clipping, and custom brushes.

Transform · Move

Universal transforms (current layer / selection / float — no tool needed)

H / Home	Flip horizontal
Ctrl+Shift+H / End	Flip vertical
> / <	Rotate 90° CW / CCW
PgUp / PgDn	Scale 2× / scale 50%
Ctrl+Home / Ctrl+End	Scale 2× horizontal / vertical (per-axis pixel-double)

When a **custom brush** is active, Home / End / PgUp / PgDn / > / < / / transform the *brush* instead (see [Custom Brush](#)).

Move tool (**V**)

Arrows move 1px · **Shift+Arrows** 10px · **Ctrl+Arrows** scale 1px · **Ctrl+Shift+Arrows** scale 10px · **Alt** (hold) clone mode · **Shift+Click** select toplevel layer at cursor & begin move · **Enter** apply · **Esc** cancel.

Edit → Transform overlay (Scale / Rotate / Shear / Distort / Perspective)

Drag handle apply mode · **Enter** apply & restore previous tool · **Esc** cancel. **Shift**: Scale=lock aspect · Rotate=snap 15° · Perspective=mirror opposite corner.

Image · Adjustments · Effects · CRT · AA

- **Image menu:** Resize Canvas, Resize Image with Content (scales pixels too), Crop, Flip Canvas H/V, and adjustments (Brightness/Contrast, Hue/Saturation, Levels, Color Balance, Blur, Sharpen, Invert, Desaturate, Posterize, Pixelate). All adjustment dialogs: sliders + **Wheel** on slider fine-tune · **OK** / **Enter** apply · **Cancel** / **Esc** revert.
- **Effects menu** (Shape / Texture / Render engines): each dialog has a split ORIG/ADJ loupe, wheel-sliders, an angle dial, seed, MIX slider, Reset. Effects can clip to selection or run selection-as-shape.
- **Last-effect shortcuts:** **Ctrl+F** re-apply last effect · **Ctrl+Alt+F** recall last effect (re-open its dialog) · **Ctrl+Shift+F** blend/fade last effect (blend modes + isolate-to-new-layer).
- **CRT effect:** **Ctrl+Alt+0** toggle · View → CRT Effect Settings...
- **Anti-Aliasing** (experimental, off by default): Edit → Anti-Aliasing toggle (status shows **AA**); Edit Bar Edge-Mode button (L-Click toggle, R-Click switch Pixel-Perfect ↔ AA). Config **ANTIALIAS**.
- **Crop tool:** **Click+Drag** region · handles resize (drag outward past an edge to *grow* the canvas) · **Arrows** nudge · **Ctrl+Arrows** resize · **Enter** apply · **Esc** cancel.

Panels · Docking

Docking

Ctrl+Shift+Click a panel → toggle dock side (left ↔ right). Panels: Toolbox, Layer Panel, Edit Bar, Advanced Bar, Character Map (View → Layout menu).

Preview window (**F4**)

Follow / Floating-Image modes (View → Preview Window). **Alt+Click** pick FG (CP enabled) · **Alt+R-Click** pick BG · **Wheel** zoom preview · drag title move · drag handle resize.

Drawer panel

F1/F2/F3 Brush/Gradient/Pattern mode · **L-Click slot** select · **Shift+L-Click** store current · **R-Click** context menu · **M-Click** cycle mode · **Shift+M-Click** clear slot · **Shift+R-Click** import into slot · **L/R-Click mini palette** set FG/BG.

Color Mixer / Image Browser

View → Color Mixer (RGB/HSV sliders, hex). View → Browser: **Click** select · **Ctrl+Click** multi-select · **Dbl-Click** load · drag file → canvas/drawer/layer-panel · **Wheel** scroll · **Dbl-Click title** maximize.

Audio · Music

}	Next track
{	Previous track
*	Play a random track

Everything else is in the **Audio** menu: Sound FX toggle/volume/mute, Music toggle/volume/mute, Random Track (per format), Explore Music, Now Playing. MIDI plays via OPL3 FM or a custom **.sf2** (Settings → Audio → MIDI Soundfont).

Drag & Drop · Image Import

Where you drop decides what happens:

Canvas	Place on current layer (undoable)
Layer panel	New layer
Brush bin (drawer)	Custom brush in next free slot (new page if full)
Menu bar	Open in a separate DRAW window

Shift while dropping centers on canvas. Images larger than the canvas open the interactive **Image Import** flow.

Image Import controls: **Drag** placement marquee · **Shift+corner** constrained resize · **Wheel** zoom · **Arrows** move box 1px · **Shift+Arrows** 10px · **Ctrl+Arrows** resize · **Alt+Arrows** pan crop · **R-Drag** pan crop · **>** / **<** rotate · **Home** / **End** flip · **Enter** apply · **Esc** cancel.

Menu Bar · Command Palette

Menu bar

Alt (tap) open/close · **Ctrl+F11** toggle · **←** / **→** navigate menus · **↑** / **↓** items · **Enter** execute · **Esc** close. Each item shows its hotkey; toggles show checkmarks.

Command Palette (?)

Type to filter (subsequence/fuzzy) · **↑** / **↓** navigate · **Enter** execute · **Esc** close · **Backspace** delete char.
Smart case: a lowercase query is case-insensitive; an ALL-CAPS query is a case-sensitive acronym match (e.g. **TDF** → the one TheDraw command).

Mouse Reference

Canvas (general)

L-Click / Drag	Draw/select with FG (tool-dependent)
R-Click	Draw with BG (Brush/Dot/Line/Rect/Ellipse/Fill/Spray)
M-Click + Drag	Pan
DbL M-Click	Reset zoom & pan
Wheel	Zoom
Space + L-Drag	Pan
Ctrl+L-Click	Set symmetry center

Per-tool (canvas)

Zoom	L-Click in · Alt +L-Click out · L-Drag zoom-to-region
Picker	L/R-Click pick FG/BG · Alt +L/R-Click temporary pick (returns tool on Alt release)
Dot	Shift +R-Click line from last point
Marquee	drag handles resize · drag inside move · Shift / Alt +Drag add/subtract
Move	drag handles scale · drag inside move · Shift +Click pick topmost layer
Bezier	Click corner anchor · Click+Drag smooth anchor · Backspace remove last · Enter commit · Esc cancel · H handles

(Layer panel, palette, drawer, preview, browser, toolbar mouse: see their sections above.)

Toolbar button extras

Text: L=VGA, R=Tiny5, M=load custom font. Open: L=open project, R=import image. Pan: M/DbL-Click resets zoom+pan. Dot: DbL-L-Click clears custom brush.

Hold-Key Chords

Hold a **non-modifier** key, then click/press/drag. Easy to miss:

F	L/R-Click	Any	Global fill (contiguous) with FG / BG across all visible layers
Shift + F	L/R-Click	Any	Replace-all global fill (FG / BG)
E	Click	Any	Flood-erase contiguous pixels to transparent
E	(as a tool)	Any	Hold to erase, release to restore previous tool
W	Click	Any	Magic-wand from merged canvas
G	Arrow	Any	Resize grid width / height independently
G	O, then click	Any	Grid-offset pick mode — click the canvas to set the grid origin (x/y offset)
G	R	Any	Reset grid offset to 0, 0
L	0–9	Smart Shapes (3D)	3D light-intensity preset (Dice / 3D Text)
R	Click	Picker	Sample the reference image instead of the canvas
Space	Drag	Any	Pan (any tool); or reposition a Smart Shape while dragging